

Path 1: Pre Security > Module 5: Operating Systems Basics > Room 4: Windows CLI Basics

<https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsclibasics>

Windows CLI Basics

Explore what Windows CLI is, how to navigate, and interact with the system using Windows CLI.

>> Task 1: Introduction

From a security perspective, Windows is important because many real-world attacks and investigations involve Windows systems.

- ♦ What Is the Windows Command Line?

The **Command Prompt** (often referred to as **CMD**) is a text-based interface for interacting with the Windows operating system. Instead of clicking folders and menus, you type commands to tell the system exactly what you want to do, such as listing files, moving between folders, or checking system information. It might look simple, but it's a powerful and widely used tool.

- ♦ Learning Objectives:

By the end of this room, you will be able to:

- Use the Windows command line confidently
- Navigate folders without clicking
- Find files when you only know their name
- Read files using the terminal
- Collect basic system and network information

>> Task 2: Windows CLI: Navigating Files and Findings Your First File

In this task, you'll learn how to explore folders, move between directories, search for a file when you don't know where it is, and read the contents of a text file, all using Command Prompt.

◆ A Quick Recap About the Terminal:

The **terminal** is a text-based interface for interacting with the Windows OS. Instead of clicking windows and folders, you type commands that tell the computer exactly what to do. cyber security professionals use it because:

- It's faster than clicking around
- It gives more control
- Many security tools only run in the terminal

Step 1: Where Am I?

Before doing anything else, open the terminal on the Desktop, and check your current location by typing the command **cd**.

This shows the full path of the directory you're currently in. On Windows, this is usually your user folder. Please note that the **cd** command is also used to change the directory, which we will use later in the task.

Step 2: What's Around Me?

Now, list the contents of the current directory using the command: **dir**

This command will list down the files and the folders present in the current directory.

Step 3: Are There Hidden Files?

Some files and folders on Windows are marked as hidden, which means they don't appear in a normal listing. To show everything, including hidden items, run: **dir /a**

Step 4: Moving Around the Filesystem

Let's use the `cd` command to navigate through the folders. We can use the format `cd folder_name` to move to the specified folder. The command `cd Documents` will move us to the Documents folder. To move back one level, we can use the `cd` command.

To become familiar with the environment, use the `dir` or `dir /a` command to move to see what's inside each folder.

Step 5: Finding the File on the Disk

Instead of guessing where the file is, let Windows search for it. Use the following command: `dir /s <file>`. The `/s` flag tells Windows to search **all subfolders** starting from your current directory and show you the full path if the file exists.

Step 6: Navigate to the File

Now that we know where the file is located, let's use the `cd` command to navigate to the folder using the command format `cd <path>` (path of file). Use `dir` again to confirm that **task_brief.txt** is in the folder.

Command: `cd C:\Users\Administrator\Documents\Notes\
dir`

Step 7: Read the File

Now read the contents of the file using: `type <file>`. This will print the contents of the file directly in the command prompt.

Q1) What is the full path of the `task_brief.txt` found on the system?

Answer:

C:\Users\Administrator\Documents\Notes\research_yn6\exports_imv\screenshots\notes_wi6

Command: `dir /s task_brief.txt`

Q2) What message and flag are written inside `task_brief.txt`?

Answer: TASK-BRIEF-FOUND

Command: `type task_brief.txt`

>> Task 3: Gathering System Information on Windows

Step 1: Who Am I Logged In As?

When working on a system, one of the first things to check is **which user account you're using**. This matters because different users can have different permissions.

Run the following command: **whoami**.

This command prints the username of the account you're currently logged into.

Step 2: What Is the Name of This Computer?

Every Windows machine has a name. In workplaces, this helps identify network systems. To see the computer's name, run: **hostname**

Step 3: What Version of Windows Is This?

Next, let's look at details about the operating system itself. Run: **systeminfo**

This command prints a lot of information.

Focus on these parts:

OS Name

OS Version

System Type

These details indicate the version of Windows the machine is running and whether it's 32-bit or 64-bit.

Step 4: How Is This Machine Connected to the Network?

Finally, let's look at basic network information. Run: **ipconfig**

This shows the machine's network configuration.

Look for:

An **IPv4 Address**

A **Default Gateway**

This information helps analysts understand how a machine connects to the network.

Q1) What is the computer name shown by hostname?

Answer: thmlab

Command: **hostname**

Q2) What Windows version is listed in the **systeminfo** output?

Answer: 10.0.17763 N/A Build 17763

Command: **systeminfo**